

Alcohol's tie to cancer in the spotlight

Surgeon general wants new warning labels on booze acknowledging the connection



The bottom line
The evidence is strong that alcohol is linked to several kinds of cancer and causes the disease in four ways. **A10.**

By Roni Caryn Rabin
NEW YORK TIMES

Alcohol is a leading preventable cause of cancer, and alcoholic beverages should carry a warning label as packs of cigarettes do, the US surgeon general said Friday.

It is the latest salvo in a fierce debate about the risks and benefits of moderate drinking as the influential US Dietary Guidelines for Americans are about to be updated. For decades, moderate drinking was said to help prevent heart attacks and strokes.

That perception has been embedded in the dietary advice given to Americans. But growing research has linked drinking, sometimes even within the recommended limits, to various types of cancer.

Labels currently affixed to bottles and cans of alcoholic beverages warn about drinking while pregnant or before driving and operating other machinery, and about general "health risks."

But alcohol directly contributes to 100,000 cancer cases and 20,000 related deaths each year, the surgeon general, Dr. Vivek Murthy, said.

He called for updating the labels to include a heightened risk of breast cancer, colon cancer, and at least five other malignancies

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Community colleges feeling the strain

Schools adding students but not resources

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Lisa Heller Boragine, who has taught communications at Cape Cod Community College for two decades, delights in seeing her students succeed. Just days ago, she said, a former student working to become a professor of English thanked her for inspiring her to pursue their doctorate.

"It's just so gratifying to know that you made a difference," she said.

But with enrollments surging after the state made community college free last fall,

Heller Boragine is among faculty and staff who say they are stretched so thin they cannot provide meaningful assistance to students.

The free tuition program, she and other teachers worry, could backfire if the schools don't have enough faculty to help students reach their academic and career goals.

"My biggest fear is that a lot of students will drop out when they don't feel like [they're] making progress," she said. "They need so much support."

At the Cape Cod college's West Barnstable campus, enrollment grew by nearly a third since last fall, to about 3,400, while the number of faculty and staff remain below

COLLEGES, Page A5

Fitful start to GOP reign

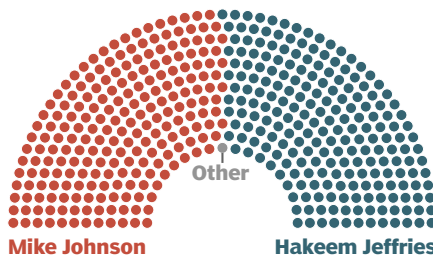
Johnson keeps post amid drama, highlighting challenge ahead

By Jim Puzzanghera, Tal Kopan, and Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The start of a new Congress Friday marked the dawn of what could be a golden era for Republicans after winning unified control of the federal government last fall. But as House members gathered for their first routine task — electing a speaker — Republicans appeared trapped in a time warp.

Speaker Mike Johnson's bid to retain his job was in trouble as three hard-right conservative members within the razor-thin Republican majority

Thinnest of margins



With literally not a single vote to spare, the reelection of Representative Mike Johnson as House speaker Friday underscored the delicate balancing act Republicans face in keeping their fractious majority together as the party assumes total control of Washington.

in the House voted against him. The revolt threatened to plunge the chamber into the same chaos of two years ago, when Republicans were unable to choose a speaker for four days in a foreshadowing of the dysfunction to come.

Some last-minute maneuvering Friday helped Johnson pull out a first-ballot win and allow new House members to be sworn in and get to work. But the drama in performing the most perfunctory task of governing doesn't bode well as Republicans grapple with balancing the slimmest House majority since the 1930s with approaching

SPEAKER, Page A7



CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: ROBERTO SCHMIDT/AFP VIA GETTY; STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS; ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE; BLOOMBERG/FILE

As Harris certifies her own loss, some see message about democracy

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — One of Vice President Kamala Harris's last responsibilities before leaving office comes on Monday, when she presides over the Senate and certifies her own loss to President-elect Donald Trump.

It will also be the anniversary of the day a violent mob broke into the Capitol to try to overturn his defeat four years ago. But it's widely expected that this year, the certification of the election on Jan. 6 will return to a peaceful, perfunctory cadence, and that the vice president will calmly perform her ceremonial role.

Nonetheless, the echoes of 2021 will be unmistakable, when Trump pressured his own vice president, Mike Pence, to reject their defeat by President Biden and Harris. Those who know Harris expect her participation this year to be quiet and routine — which, they say, will speak volumes.

Retiring Representative Barbara Lee of California, a longtime Harris ally, was

HARRIS, Page A7



On Monday, Vice President Kamala Harris will certify Donald Trump's victory over her.



In 2021, the certification of the election results was not smooth or peaceful, as is expected this year. Trump supporters stormed the Capitol and delayed the certification by then-Vice President Mike Pence.

'Six of the last eight games, tickets were going below face value.'

JIM HOLZMAN, owner, Ace Ticket

Need 2? How about 10? Patriots tickets abound.



There were plenty of empty seats in the second half of last week's blowout loss to the Chargers at Gillette Stadium.

By Michael Silverman
GLOBE STAFF

The Patriots' lopsided losing season will be put out of its misery Sunday at Gillette Stadium.

Unsurprisingly, there's no clamor to witness the final moments.

"Demand has plummeted" for the game, said Jim Holzman, owner of Ace Ticket. "There's just more sellers than ever. Six of the last eight games, tickets were going below face value. That's never happened before — this century."

Heading into the weekend, it looked as if a case of measles had broken out on Ticketmaster's seating chart at Gillette Stadium.

Each of the thousands of pink dots represents a seat a ticket holder is trying to unload, some at cut-rate prices, plus a few hundred blue dots for previously-held tickets the Patriots were putting on the market at face value.

Roughly one-third of the 64,628-seat venue appeared to be up for grabs, a graphic display of the lack of local desire to get up close and personal with what is arguably the worst team in the

TICKETS, Page C2

President Biden blocked the \$14 billion takeover of US Steel by Nippon Steel of Japan based on grounds that the sale posed a threat to national security. **A2.**

Syria's new leaders met the French and German foreign ministers in Damascus in one of the highest-level Western diplomatic visits since the fall of President Bashar Assad. **A4.**

An independent state agency failed to adequately monitor the financial condition of Massachusetts hospitals, according to a state auditor's report. **B1.**

Brandeis University plans to suspend thousands of alumni email accounts on Jan. 8, despite months of protest from former graduates. **D1.**



Go for the cold

Saturday: Sunny, cold. High: 31-36. Low: 23-28.

Sunday: Sunny, cold. High: 32-37. Low: 18-23.

Sunrise: 7:13 Sunset: 4:25

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